

FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY - Source Selection Information – See FAR 2.101 and 3.104

Justification and Approval (J&A)
for Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Subpart 13.5
Other than Full and Open Competition
Sole Source Acquisition

Title: Health Information and Management System Society Premier Level Organizational Affiliate Program Membership

J&A Number: JA-25-0333

1. Identification of the agency and contracting activity:

Professional Services Contracting Division

The requiring activity is the Defense Health Agency (DHA), Program Executive Office Medical System (PEO MS)/Chief Information Officer (CIO)(J 6), CIO Operations Division. The contracting activity for this acquisition is the Defense Health Agency Contracting Activity, Professional Services Contracting Division, at DHA.

2. Nature and/or Description of Action being Approved:

new contract

This justification requests authority to procure the Premier Level Organizational Affiliate Program (PLOAP) membership subscription on a sole source basis. The proposed source is Healthcare Information and Management Systems Society (HIMSS), 350 N Orleans Street, Suite 1000S, Chicago, IL 60654-1701. The resultant contract award will have a contract type of Firm-Fixed Price (FFP).

3. Description of Supplies/ Services:

The PEO MS/CIO (J-6), CIO Operations Division has a need for an annual HIMSS PLOAP membership subscription. The PEO MS/CIO (J-6) CIO Operations Division utilizes HIMSS Organizational Affiliate Program membership as a baseline to assist with the following:

- o Execute mission and business activities.
- o Provide additional information needed for operations.
- o Research new technologies needed to support operations.
- o Implement new processes and technologies to support changing business activities.

HIMSS PLOAP membership provides the end user access to a national and local chapter online network which is crucial to making effective investments, supporting business objective alignments, acceleration of digital health transformation and the application of enterprise-wide Information Technology standards and processes. The most critical of these being the access to content expertise, professional development resources, research initiatives, access to web based/online news and resource library/database, and media vehicles designed to promote information and management systems' contributions to patient care.

A FFP contract will be awarded to the contractor, HIMSS. The Period of Performance will be for a one (1), six-month base period and three (3), twelve-month Option periods from 09 March 2025 to 08 September 2028. A six-month extension period under Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 52.217-8, Option to Extend Services has been included to account for any delays in awarding the follow-on effort.

<u>TOTAL Contract Value</u> POP: From 3/9/2025 to 3/8/2029 Estimated Value \$788,000.00	<u>BASE</u> POP: From 3/9/2025 to 9/8/2025 Estimated Value [REDACTED]
Type of Contract (Primary) FAR 16.202 Firm-Fixed-Price	<u>Options:</u> Yes Number of Option 3 POP (All options): From 9/9/2025 to 9/8/2028 Estimated Value (all options): [REDACTED]
Funding Type: Operations & Maintenance (O&M)	<u>Extension of Services:</u> Yes Clause: FAR 52.217-8 Estimated Value: [REDACTED] Number of Months: 6

4. Statutory Authority Cited permitting other than full and open competition:

41 U.S.C. 1901 Simplified Acquisition Procedure

The statutory authority permitting other than full and open competition is 41 U.S.C. 1901, as implemented in FAR 13.501(a)(1)(ii), sole source (including brand name) under the authority of the simplified procedures for certain commercial items.

5. Rationale Justifying Use of the Statutory Authority Cited:

Market Research indicated that HIMSS is an exclusive organization without any competition and operates as a non-profit organization. HIMSS is an industry leader in healthcare practices as its board members are top executives in both vendor companies and healthcare provided systems who serve a three-year term to help grow and lead in the industry. Department of Defense, Veteran Affairs, National Institute of Health, Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency and Social Security Administration have jointly concluded that HIMSS' analytics provides access to comprehensive healthcare data and research that support improved decision making for Government and outside agencies. HIMSS demonstrates innovation in Government by delving into the critical themes shaping the future of healthcare cybersecurity, artificial intelligence, and the drive towards seamless interoperability across healthcare systems. Training employees and loading data on any other existing or new system would result in a duplication of cost. Therefore, the Government's technical experts determined that HIMSS is the only source that can meet the Government's minimum requirements.

6. Efforts to Obtain Competition:

The Government utilized several methods to obtain competition for this effort. The requiring activity reviewed mandatory sources, and results of market research from previously awarded contracts with similar scopes. Additionally, a Notice of Intent (NOI) is required by FAR Subpart 5.2. The NOI was posted to SAM.gov on 17 October 2024 for a total of 15 days and closed on 01 November 2024. As a result, the Government received only one (1) capability statement from the large business, [REDACTED] in response to the posting on SAM.gov.

7. Determination that Anticipated Cost to the Government will be Fair and Reasonable:

The Contracting Officer will determine the anticipated cost to the Government will be fair and reasonable through a comparison of the contractor's proposed rates to current and historical pricing of the same required services needed for this contract action.

8. Market Research:

Market Research Conducted? ☒ Yes
When was it conducted? 9/6/2024 to 10/17/2024
Description:

In accordance with FAR Part 10, Market Research was conducted by the Government from 06 September 2024 to 17 October 2024. The requiring activity conducted market research by reviewing mandatory sources, internet searches, and reviewing results of market research from previously awarded contract with similar scopes. Market research indicated that only one (1) source, HIMSS is capable of providing the PLOAP memberships as required by the Performance Work Statement. HIMSS is the sole provider for the membership services of this nature and is the only source capable of providing the membership services required for this effort.

Additionally, as identified in section 6 above, an NOI was posted to SAM.gov on 17 November 2024 for a total of 15 days and closed on 01 November 2024. The Government received only one (1) capability statement from the source, [REDACTED] to the posting on SAM.gov. The requiring activity reviewed their capability statement and found that the services offered by [REDACTED] does not correlate to the requirement and did not demonstrate the capability needed to provide the required membership services.

9. Other Facts:

Not Applicable.

10. Interested Sources:

As identified in section 8 above, a NOI was posted to SAM.gov on 17 October 2024 for a total of 15 days and closed on 01 November 2024. As a result, the Government received one (1) response from the large business, [REDACTED] in response to the NOI posting on SAM.gov. The requiring activity reviewed their capability statement and found that the services offered by [REDACTED] does not correlate to the requirement and did not demonstrate the capability needed to provide the required membership services.

11. Actions to overcome barriers:

The Government will continue to conduct Market Research to ascertain if there are changes in the marketplace that would enable future actions to competed.

Coordination & Approval

12. Technical/Functional Representative:

I certify that the information provided in this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Name ☐ [REDACTED] Title [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

Comments:

13. Requirements Certification:

I certify that the information provided in this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief

Name: ☐ [REDACTED] Title: [REDACTED]

J-Directorate Office: [REDACTED]

Approved: [REDACTED]

Comments:

14. Fair and Reasonable Cost Determination:

See section 7 for fair and reasonable price determination. Certified cost or pricing data is not required in accordance with FAR 15.403-1(c)(3).

I have determined that the anticipated cost to the Government for this contract action is fair and reasonable.

Name: ☐ WOOD, DESTINY Title: Contracting Officer, Professional Services Contracting Division

Approved: WOOD, DESTINY - 6 Jan 2025, 11:57:17

Comments:

15. Legal Review:

I have reviewed this justification and have found it to be legally sufficient.

Name ☐ [REDACTED] Title [REDACTED]

Approved: [REDACTED]

Comments:

16. Contracting Officer:

I certify that this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Name: ☐ WOOD, DESTINY Title: Contracting Officer, Professional Services Contracting Division

Approved: WOOD, DESTINY - 7 Jan 2025, 11:26:36

Comments:

17. Competition Advocate: Based on the foregoing justification, I hereby approve the procurement of Health Information and Management System Society Premier Level Organizational Affiliate Program Membership on an other than full and open competition basis pursuant to the authority of 41 U.S.C. 1901 Simplified Acquisition Procedures, subject to availability of funds, and provided that the supplies and/or services herein described have otherwise been authorized for acquisition.

[REDACTED]

Comments: